

Irene Hagström

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Berlin

Summary

Bringing 20+ years of experience across product design, UX, and business analysis, with a focus on designing and scaling complex digital products in technical environments. Currently leading design teams and driving the execution of user-centred solutions that align product, engineering, and business priorities. Experienced in translating complex requirements into intuitive user experiences, combining strong research, data analysis, and design thinking methodologies. Proven ability to operate across the full product lifecycle, from discovery and strategy through to delivery and optimisation. Background spans startups, scaleups, and enterprise environments, with additional experience in operations, process optimisation, and organisational setup, enabling a holistic approach to product and team development.

KEY SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- **Leadership & team development:** Leading and mentoring designers, performance management, hiring and onboarding, talent development, establishing team culture and ways of working
- **Product & UX design:** End-to-end product design, UX/UI design, user journeys, prototyping, information architecture, fashion design
- **Research & strategy:** Qualitative and quantitative user research, market analysis, stakeholder workshops, benchmarking, and data-driven decision-making
- **Business analysis & process optimization:** Requirements gathering, business process modeling and workflow optimisation
- **Cross-functional collaboration & delivery:** Close collaboration with Product, Engineering, and stakeholders, translating requirements into solutions, aligning design with business goals
- **Business Operations & Project Management:** Process improvement, HR and operational setup in scaling environments, stakeholder management, workshop facilitation and project management
- **Branding & digital design:** Visual identities, corporate branding, website design and optimisation, marketing assets and print collateral

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Interactive Multimedia** – University of Technology Sydney, Australia 2002 - 2004
- **Bachelor of Science in Product Development Engineering** – University of Skövde, Sweden 1996 -1999
- **Certified Professional for Requirements Engineering** – Sophist GmbH, Berlin 2012
- **Mastering the Requirements Process** – Software Education, Sydney, Australia 2010
- **3D CAD Modelling & Multimedia** – Griffith University, Gold Coast, Australia 1999

TOOLS

Figma, Miro, Adobe Suite, Jira, PostHog, HTML/CSS, WordPress, AI tools and Vibe coding and more

INDUSTRIES

Tech, E-commerce, Education, Publishing, Compliance, Textile, Nanotechnology, Media

LANGUAGES

Swedish	Native
English	Proficient
German	Proficient
Spanish	Basi

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Design Manager

Aiven, Berlin
Dec 2025 – Present

- Leading and developing a high-performing design team, driving capability building through coaching, performance management, and structured talent development (incl. hiring, onboarding, and succession planning)
- Defining team goals and design direction, fostering a culture of accountability, quality, and continuous improvement
- Driving the strategic and operational execution of design initiatives, ensuring alignment between user experience, product strategy, and business priorities
- Establishing and optimising design processes, tools, and ways of working to improve delivery efficiency and consistency
- Partnering closely with Product, Engineering, and Marketing to embed design into cross-functional decision-making and product development

Senior Product Designer

Aiven, Berlin
April 2024 – Nov 2025

- Led design for complex, highly technical products, owning the end-to-end design process from discovery through to implementation
- Translated complex technical requirements into intuitive user experiences through research, data analysis, and iterative prototyping
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops and aligned cross-functional teams to refine product features and improve usability
- Applied user research, benchmarking, and analytics to inform design decisions and enhance product effectiveness
- Mentored junior designers, contributing to team capability and design quality

UX Designer

Aiven, Berlin
Oct 2021 – March 2024

- Designed user flows and interfaces for cloud, database, and networking products, applying structured UX methodologies across the product lifecycle
- Conducted user research, journey mapping, and usability testing to validate solutions and improve user experience
- Collaborated closely with Product and Engineering to translate requirements into scalable design solutions
- Delivered wireframes, prototypes, and high-fidelity designs using tools such as Figma

Office Manager

Aiven, Berlin
Jan 2020 – Sep 2021

- Built core HR processes, policies, and workplace operations from scratch during rapid startup growth and office expansion
- Established and managed office operations, employee benefits, IT procurement, internal travel booking tools and corporate policies to improve efficiency

- Led office relocation, ensuring seamless transitions and workspace optimizations

Marketing Lead & Operations

LKzwo GmbH, Berlin
Aug 2015 – Jan 2020

- Multidisciplinary operations and marketing role in a small business environment
- Owning marketing execution, including branding materials and designing, building, and maintaining the company websites.
- Designed corporate branding and website development for clients
- Supported leadership with travel and finance administration

Service Design Manager / Product Owner

Cornelsen Verlag, Berlin
Apr 2012 – Jul 2013

- Led requirements engineering and UX research for e-learning platforms, bridging business, user, and technical perspectives
- Defined and delivered digital solutions, including competency evaluation and training tools for educational institutions
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops to gather requirements, validate concepts, and align on product direction

Senior Business Analyst

Standards Australia, Sydney
Feb 2006 – Nov 2011

- Led requirements gathering, stakeholder workshops, and validation processes for digital and operational initiatives
- Designed and implemented a web-based document management and workflow system, improving process efficiency and compliance
- Drove internal process optimisation initiatives, enhancing operational effectiveness and regulatory alignment
- Developed corporate guidelines, service agreements, and organisation-wide process improvements

Project Manager

Standards Australia, Sydney
Feb 2004 – Feb 2006

- Facilitated expert IT standards committees in the development of Australian and International ISO Standards
- Organised state and national committee meetings and seminars
- Coordinated and hosted international ISO plenary meetings
- Established new communication methods and work processes for committees

Graphic & Web Designer

Triple-O Microscopy GmbH, Berlin
Jun 2001 – Jun 2002

- Designed and maintained corporate websites, product manuals, and marketing materials
- Developed animations, graphics, and branding assets for scientific products

**Screen Designer /
Team Lead**

dooyoo AG, Berlin, Germany
Jul 2000 – Mar 2001

- Managed e-commerce platform redesigns and usability testings
- Created website graphics, animations, and digital brandings

Freelance work

2001-2025

Various clients across tech, scientific products, food, and events

- Delivered branding, digital design, and website projects for clients across multiple industries (tech, scientific products, food, events)
- Designed visual identities, UI elements, and marketing assets, including print-ready materials and animations
- Analysed market metrics and provided reporting to support client decision-making
- Analysed the cashier interface and underlying business processes of an indoor play park, delivering recommendations for a more streamlined and efficient solution